COLIN GIERER

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EDUCATION

James Madison University (JMU) — Harrisonburg, VA *Expected May 2027*
B.B.A. Computer Information Systems
Relevant Coursework: Business Analytics I & II; Computer Information Systems; Principles of Programming; Financial & Managerial Accounting; Integrative Business Management, Finance, Operations and Marketing; Introduction to Micro/Macroeconomics

Academies of Loudoun — Ashburn, VA *Aug 2021 – Jun 2022*
Cybersecurity Program — MATA Cybersecurity I & II (Dual Enrollment)

Riverside High School — Leesburg, VA *Jun 2023*
GPA: 3.7/4.0 | National Honor Society | State Championship Crew Team

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Network+ — CompTIA *Obtained Aug 2026*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & LLM Tools: Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Gemini; experienced leveraging AI to increase productivity, automate workflows, and solve technical problems; built a full application using Claude Code with structured prompt engineering
APIs & Integrations: Integrated third-party REST APIs into a personal app project; foundational understanding of API calls, requests, responses, and data flow;
SQL & Databases: Direct SQL queries (SELECT, JOIN, WHERE, etc.) using SQLite; database design, ERD modeling, and normalization; Python-based database programming
Programming & Web: Python; JavaScript; HTML/CSS; built and deployed colingierer.net from scratch on AWS with full DNS configuration
SaaS & Productivity Tools: Microsoft Teams; Microsoft Excel (pivot tables, dashboards, data analysis); PowerPoint (animations, visual design); Word
Version Control & Deployment: GitHub for source control; Netlify hosting and deployment
Technical Communication: Experienced translating complex technical concepts for non-technical audiences (CIS 330); technical documentation and process diagrams using UML Activity Diagrams and Gliffy
Networking & Security: Cisco Packet Tracer, TCP/IP, Firewalls, Risk Assessment/Modeling; cloud and network architecture diagrams

PROJECTS

AI-Powered Application

- Built a fully functional application using Claude Code, integrating a third-party REST API to connect with external services
- Applied structured prompt engineering to guide LLM behavior and optimize outputs throughout development
- Managed the full software development lifecycle: requirements, design, build, testing, and iteration
- Demonstrates hands-on experience with AI tools, API integrations, and end-to-end technical problem solving

SQL Database Project (CIS 330)

- Designed and implemented a relational database using Python and SQLite with direct SQL queries (SELECT, JOIN, WHERE)
- Created full ERD documentation and normalization plans following database design best practices
- Produced written technical documentation explaining the system architecture to a non-technical audience, demonstrating the ability to bridge technical and business communication

Personal Portfolio Website — colingierer.net

- Built from scratch using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript with no templates; deployed to Netlify with GitHub version control
- Managed full DNS configuration including A records, CNAME, and nameserver setup

COB 300 Business Presentation

- Delivered a formal presentation to a panel of business stakeholders, communicating both technical and business value propositions
- Demonstrated ability to present complex solutions clearly to a variety of internal and external audiences

WORK EXPERIENCE

Marketing Intern, **Vent Now** — Remote *May 2026 – Aug 2026*

- Achieved a 381 CPM (cost per thousand impressions) across social media advertising campaigns
- Developed hands-on understanding of how social media algorithms rank and surface content to reach target audiences

DoorDash Driver, **DoorDash** — Harrisonburg, VA *May 2023 – Jul 2025*

- Managed logistics, route optimization, and real-time problem-solving independently in a fast-paced environment
- Maintained strong customer satisfaction through clear communication and reliable execution

Waiter, **The Zone USA** — Ashburn, VA *May 2022 – Nov 2023*

- Delivered high-quality guest experiences while managing multiple priorities simultaneously
- Collaborated with team members to resolve issues quickly and maintain smooth operations
- Operated POS systems and handled cash and credit transactions accurately

VOLUNTEER & CLUB EXPERIENCE

Lions Heart Volunteer, — Leesburg, VA *Aug 2019 – Jun 2023*

- Completed 100+ hours of community service demonstrating long-term commitment to giving back

Member, **Ski and Snowboard Club Team** — JMU *Sep 2025 – Present*